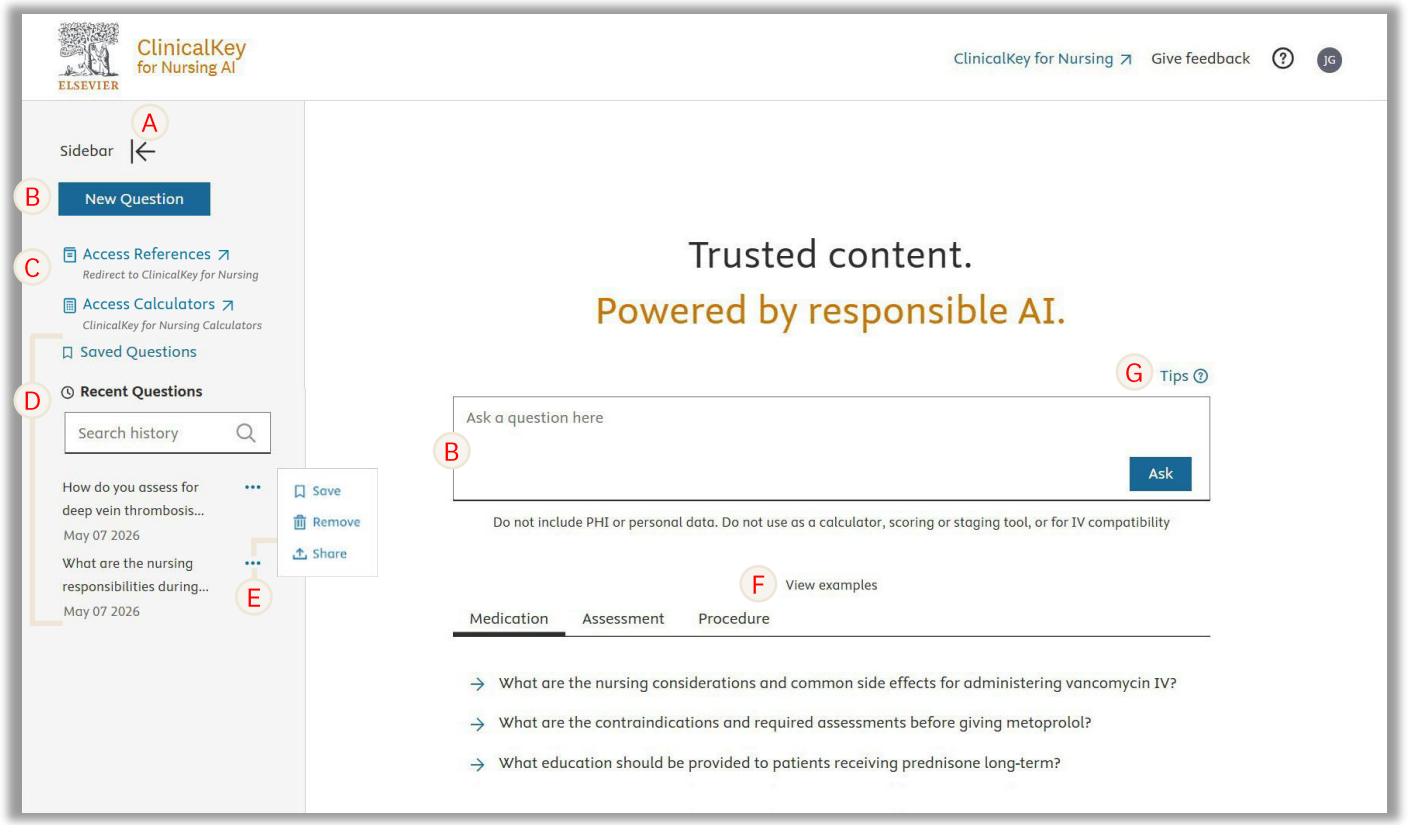
ClinicalKey Nursing AI

Get started guide

ClinicalKey Nursing AI is a clinical decision support solution that aids nurses by combining trusted, evidence-based clinical content with generative AI to transform complexity into clarity.



ClinicalKey Nursing AI landing page (signed in).

A. Hide/show privacy panel.

B. Ask a new question—basic to complex—in natural language.

C. Access **references** or **calculators.**

D. Review **saved favorites** and **recent questions,** or **search previous queries**.

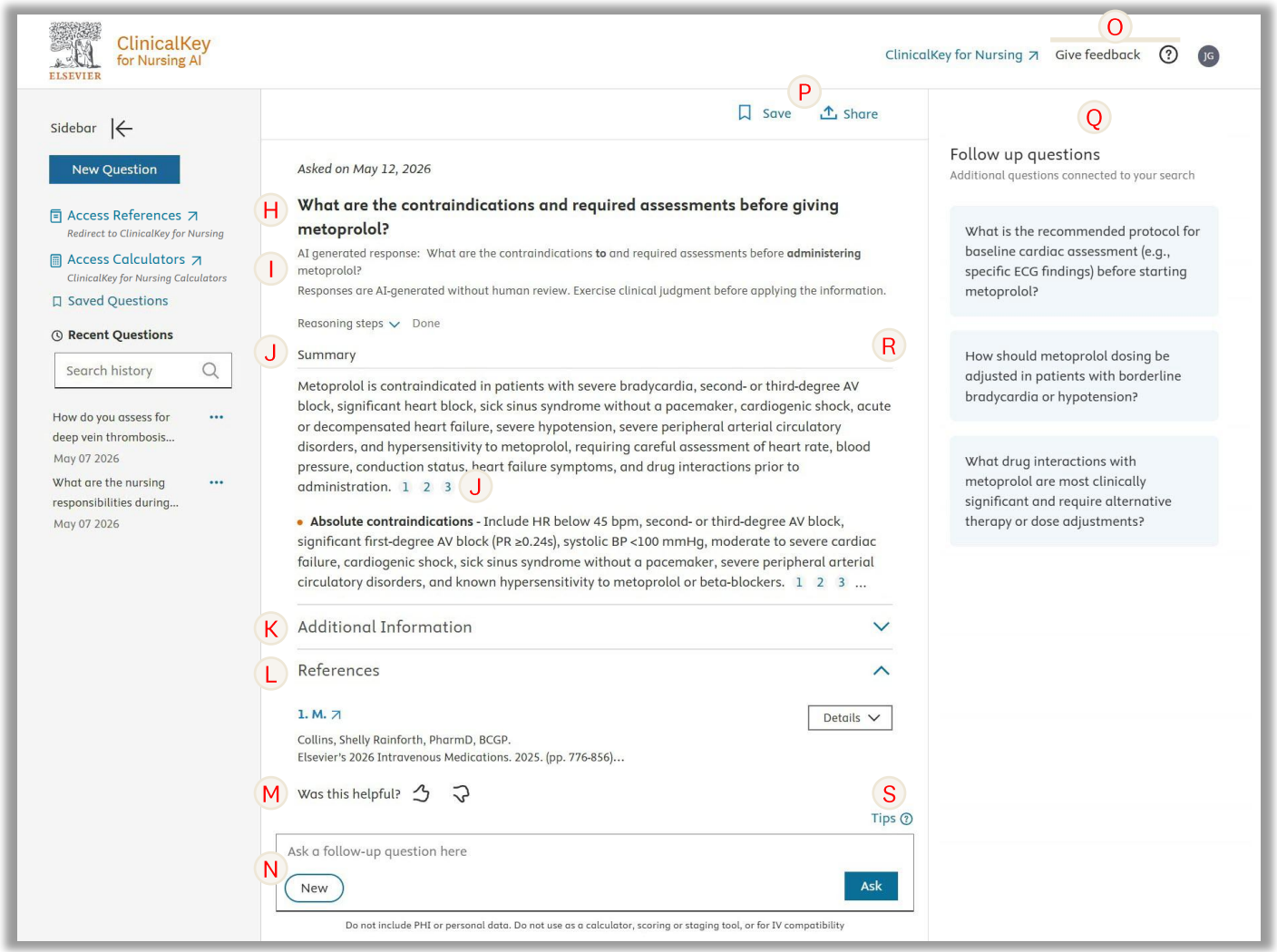
E. Save, remove, or **share*** recent questions.
*If sharing is configured

F. View **sample queries** by category.

G. View **Tips** for writing effective queries.

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Fast, clear answers



ClinicalKey Nursing AI query results.

H. View the **question you entered.**

I. Check the **AI-generated interpretation of your question,** which was used to run the query.

J. Review the **summary** of the AI-generated response, which includes citation numbers linked to the References section (L).

K. View **additional information,** with links to References section (L).

L. Explore **references** cited in Summary (J) and Additional Information (K) sections. Click ***Details*** for a verbatim excerpt.

M. Give quick feedback on this response with **thumbs up or down.**

N. Ask **follow-up question.**

O. Give feedback or get **help.**

P. Save or **share** (if sharing is configured).

Q. View **suggested follow-up questions.**

R. View in other **language.*** Toggle appears here if query is in supported non-English language, e.g., View in Spanish.

S. View **Tips** for writing effective queries.

*Content is in US English. Translation is of main response, Additional Information, and Follow-up Questions.

Translation support for French, German, Spanish, Italian, and Portuguese is included.

While the system may support additional non-English translations, those languages have not been validated. The list of supported languages will grow over time.

Best Practices

Use these tips to make the most of ClinicalKey Nursing AI's conversational search with summarization powered by generative AI to quickly receive trusted, evidence-based clinical content to help you answer clinical questions.

1. Include details for a more relevant response.

ClinicalKey Nursing AI is optimized to answer questions. Instead of using just keywords, which will return a very broad answer, rephrase your entry as a detailed question to get a better response.

2. Be as explicit as possible.

Responses are designed to be succinct and cover a broad population. If you are looking for specific information, such as details for a particular demographic, condition, or drug, ask about it. Otherwise, the information might not appear in the response.

3. Do not include protected health information (PHI) or any other personal data.*

*If your organization has executed a business associate agreement (BAA) with us that is in effect, this may not apply; ask your administrator if unsure.

4. Do not use as a calculator, as a scoring or staging tool, for medication dose conversions, or to confirm IV compatibility.

ClinicalKey Nursing AI is not designed to provide clinical calculations, such as dosages by weight, or to be used as a scoring or staging tool. Always check these types of calculations yourself by using appropriate, trusted local sources. Any unsolicited calculation or score provided by the AI system must not be used in decision making.†

5. Avoid asking for the "best" choice.

In general, no logic or rule set is applied to your query. For example, ClinicalKey Nursing AI does not weigh pro and con options to determine the "best" choice. A better way for you to determine what is best is by asking for a list of options with the key rationale for determining the selection.

†Clinical calculators are available via ClinicalKey for Nursing. Contact Elsevier Support to learn more.

6. Refrain from asking for medication costs or coverage by insurance.

At this time, these queries cannot be answered accurately because ClinicalKey Nursing AI does not have access to that information.

7. If at first you don't succeed, try again!

If you don't get the answer you're looking for at first, enter a follow-up question to clarify further. Follow-up questions suggested by ClinicalKey Nursing AI also can help clarify or narrow down answers.

8. Check for further details in the Additional Information section.

Tips continued on next page

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For more information about ClinicalKey Nursing AI, watch this video introduction.

Best Practices

9.  **Persona prompts are not needed.**

ClinicalKey Nursing AI is designed to answer clinical questions, so you don't need to use role/ persona prompts (e.g., "act as a medical assistant").

10.  **Use the Reference links to find more comprehensive information.**

You can quickly validate the response's accuracy with the *Show Details* drop-down for each cited source. This will display the relevant excerpt of the content from which the response was created.

11.  **Get query assistance from the Examples section on the home page or the Tips feature.**

The follow-up questions that ClinicalKey Nursing AI suggests can also provide good examples of queries to use.

12.  **Practice using the software to get a feel for what works best!**

Recommendations	Cautions
• Ask a clinical question with patient **context,** nursing role, and care setting. Example: *How should I monitor for pain in an older adult post-op hip fracture patient with significant confusion, hearing loss, and mild dementia at baseline?*	• Avoid vague **keywords** or single terms. They may return broad results. Example: Hip fracture care
• Ask a **specific, explicitly stated** nursing question. Example: *What should I monitor after giving IV furosemide to a patient with heart failure, and what findings should I escalate?*	• Avoid **broad, nonspecific** questions. Example: *What should I monitor after giving furosemide?*
• Ensure your prompt does not contain any **protected health information (PHI)** or any other **personal data.***	• Remember to not include **PHI** or any other **personal data.***
• Use one of the **calculators included in ClinicalKey for Nursing.**	• ClinicalKey Nursing AI is not designed for **clinical calculations** nor to be used as a **scoring or staging tool.**
• Phrase a query as if you were **asking a senior nurse, preceptor, educator, or clinical specialist.** Example: *I'm caring for a patient with new confusion and possible sepsis and have orders for blood cultures. How do I determine the best sites to use to draw the cultures?*	• **Traditional prompt engineering** format is unnecessary. Example: *Act as an expert ICU nurse, and tell me everything about sepsis.*
• Stick to **clinical queries** for best results.	• Do not ask about medication **costs** or **insurance** coverage.
• Ask questions that support **prioritization and clinical judgment.** Example: *I have a patient with COPD, diabetes, and chronic kidney disease who is newly febrile and more confused. What should I assess first, and what red flags should I watch for?*	• Avoid asking the AI to **replace clinical logic.** Example: *What is the best treatment for a patient with COPD, diabetes, and chronic kidney disease who is newly febrile and more confused?*

*If your organization has executed a business associate agreement (BAA) with us that is in effect, this may not apply; ask your administrator if unsure.

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For more information about ClinicalKey Nursing AI, visit the Support Center.

Content & Responsible AI

Trusted Content

Content is carefully curated for the clinical use case.

- ClinicalKey Nursing AI draws from a growing set of curated, evidence-based sources, including:
  - Elsevier's proprietary ClinicalKey point-of-care content
    - Clinical Overviews
    - Drug Monographs
    - Drug Class Overviews
  - Step-by-step procedural guidance across varying specialties from Elsevier's Clinical Skills
  - Medical reference texts
    - *AACN Procedure Manual for Progressive and Critical Care,* 8th ed.
    - *Saunders Nursing Drug Handbook 2026*
    - *Nursing Care Plans,* 11th ed.
    - *Sheehy's Manual of Emergency Care,* 8th ed.
    - *Goldman–Cecil Medicine,* 27th ed.
  - Full-text articles and copyright-cleared abstracts from top journals, available from Elsevier and selected non-Elsevier publishers
    - *The Lancet Healthy Longevity*
    - *Infectious Disease Clinics*
    - *Nursing Clinics of North America*
    - *Critical Care Nursing Clinics of America*
  - Selected US government publications (FDA, CDC)
  - Guidelines from leading medical and professional organizations
- Content is updated as new evidence is published and existing materials are revised.

Responsible AI

AI and machine learning are used responsibly.

- ClinicalKey Nursing AI is committed to relentless improvement via continuous collaboration and a well-defined Clinician-in-the-loop evaluation process.
  - Consistent use of evaluation dimensions and scoring increases reliability and allows for comparison over time.
  - Regular evaluation includes credentialed, licensed, current or recently practicing clinicians.
- Examples of how ClinicalKey Nursing AI aligns with Elsevier's Responsible AI Principles:
  - Retrieval augmented generation (RAG) architecture provides guardrails to minimize hallucinations.
  - An AI-generated interpretation of the query is displayed for transparency.
  - Responses are sourced from evidence-based content with in-line references.
  - Linked references enable verification.
  - Real-time evidence tracking promotes traceability.
  - Thumbs up/down enables users to participate in improving quality.
  - HIPAA protection for your data ensures secure and responsible use within your workflow.

Ease of Use

ClinicalKey Nursing AI is designed for point-of-care use.

- ClinicalKey Nursing AI is optimized for conversational language and supports medical abbreviations.
- Easy-to-digest answers are formatted for the busy nurse.
- Every response includes references with linked citations to supporting published evidence.
- A quick view of the relevant section of each citation is available.
- Suggested follow-up questions are automatically generated.
- Queries are saved with time-stamped responses.
- Responsive design enables access across multiple devices (desktop or mobile).
- Built for your enterprise, SSO, SMART on FHIR, API, and link resolvers integrate cleanly and easily.

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